> make a vital contribution to security and stability. With respect to nuclear testing, I believe that so long as we rely on nuclear weapons as an element of deterrence, we must continue to test in order to assure their continued safety, security and reliability. However, as I wrote to you in December, I see no reason why we should not consider the matter of nuclear testing as we move forward on other arms control subjects. I suggested that we establish a bilateral dialogue aimed at constructive steps in this field. I remain hopeful you will take up this offer. . . .

Then I listed what I thought of as a sweeping package of new proposals aimed at reducing nuclear, conventional, and chemical weapons; in the strategic area, it called for a reduction of warheads on strategic ballistic missiles on both sides to forty-five hundred and the number of ALCMs (air-launched cruise missiles) on heavy bombers to fifteen hundred,

> resulting in a total number of no more than 6000 such warheads on strategic nuclear delivery vehicles . . . in the INF area, by 1987, both the United States and the Soviet Union would limit their LRINF [longrange intermediate nuclear force] missile deployments in Europe to no more than 140 launchers each (this is in line with my proposal for a staged reduction of weapons) with the Soviet Union making concurrent proportionate reductions in Asia. Within the following year, both sides would further reduce the number of launchers remaining in Europe and Asia by 50 per cent. Finally, both sides would move to the total elimination of this category of weapons by the end of 1989.

Our proposal also called for broad cutbacks in conventional forces in Europe.